

The Small Business AI Prompt Quick-Start

5 ready-to-use prompts — one each for Marketing, Support, Finance, Hiring, and Sales — plus a 5-question self-audit.

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How to use this

Each prompt below works with any modern AI chat assistant (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, or similar). Replace anything in [BRACKETS] with your own details, then paste the whole prompt in. These are one real prompt from each of the 5 categories in the full playbook — not a cut-down teaser, each one is complete and usable on its own.

MARKETING & CONTENT

1. Weekly Social Content Batch

Act as a social media copywriter for [BUSINESS NAME], a [BUSINESS TYPE] that helps [TARGET CUSTOMER] with [MAIN BENEFIT]. Take this single topic: "[TOPIC]". Turn it into 5 posts, one each for Instagram, LinkedIn, Facebook, X/Twitter, and an email teaser. Match tone to each platform, keep each under the platform's practical length, and end every post with one clear call to action: [DESIRED ACTION, e.g. 'book a call', 'reply to this email'].

When to use it: Monday planning session — turn one idea into a week of content in one pass.

Adapt it: Paste 2-3 examples of your best-performing past posts before the prompt so the tone matches your actual voice, not a generic one.

CUSTOMER SERVICE & SUPPORT

2. Difficult Email Response Drafter

A customer sent this message: "[PASTE CUSTOMER MESSAGE]". Our situation/policy is: [EXPLAIN CONSTRAINTS, e.g. 'we can't refund after 30 days but can offer store credit']. Draft a reply that acknowledges their frustration specifically (not generically), explains the situation plainly without being defensive, and offers the best resolution we can actually give. Keep it under 150 words.

When to use it: Any time a customer email needs a careful, de-escalating response.

Adapt it: Never send the first draft unread — always personalize at least the opening line yourself.

FINANCE & OPERATIONS

3. Expense Categorization Assistant

Here is a list of raw transactions (date, description, amount): [PASTE LIST]. Categorize each into one of: [YOUR CATEGORIES, e.g. Rent, Payroll, Software, Marketing, Supplies, Travel, Other]. Flag any transaction where the category is ambiguous instead of guessing. Return as a table plus a one-line total per category at the end.

When to use it: Monthly bookkeeping cleanup before it goes to your accountant.

Adapt it: Always have your accountant/bookkeeper verify categorization for tax purposes — this speeds up prep, it doesn't replace review.

4. Job Description Generator

We need to hire a [ROLE]. Here's a rough list of what they'd actually do day to day: [PASTE ROUGH RESPONSIBILITIES]. Write a job description with: a short compelling intro about the role's impact, 5-7 responsibilities, 4-5 requirements split into 'must have' and 'nice to have', and a one-line note on compensation range placeholder. Review the language for anything that could unintentionally discourage qualified candidates (overly aggressive requirements lists, gendered language, etc.) and flag it.

When to use it: Opening a new role or refreshing a stale job post that isn't attracting candidates.

Adapt it: Post the 'must have' list separately from 'nice to have' in the actual listing — bundling them scares off good candidates who don't check every box.

5. Cold Outreach Email Personalizer

Here's public information about a prospect: [PASTE LINKEDIN BIO / COMPANY NEWS / RECENT POST]. We sell [PRODUCT/SERVICE] which helps companies like theirs with [SPECIFIC BENEFIT]. Write a cold email: a personalized opening line referencing something specific and true about them (not generic flattery), 2 sentences connecting their likely situation to our benefit, and one low-friction call to action. Under 100 words total.

When to use it: Any outbound prospecting, especially for higher-value targets worth the extra 5 minutes of research.

Adapt it: If you can't find one genuinely specific detail about the prospect, don't fake one — send a shorter, honest, non-personalized version instead.

Your 60-Second AI-Readiness Self-Audit

- [] Do you have a repeatable way to turn one idea into a week of content, or do you start from a blank page each time?
- [] Does an upset-customer email get a careful, specific reply — or a generic one because you're rushed?
- [] Are your expenses categorized as you go, or all at once in a scramble before tax time?
- [] Does your job posting language actually invite qualified candidates, or quietly scare off good ones?
- [] Do you personalize outreach with something true and specific, or send the same email to everyone?

If two or more of those made you wince a little, that's normal — most small business owners are doing all five without a repeatable system. These 5 prompts are one from each category in the full Small Business AI Prompt Playbook, which has 25 total across Marketing, Support, Finance, Hiring, and Sales — plus a spreadsheet tracker that logs the time and money each one saves you. Volume 2 covers a different problem entirely: turning these one-off prompts into repeatable systems (automation, customer lifecycle, competitive intel, reporting, delegation).

The Small Business AI Prompt Playbook — \$19 • AI Prompt Playbook Vol. 2: Systems & Automation — \$19 • both together as The AI Prompt Playbook Bundle — \$29.